

Present Perfect

How to Use the Present Perfect in English

1. What is the Present Perfect?

We use the **present perfect** when the **time period is unfinished**—when we are still *in* the time frame we're talking about.

If something happened **today**, **this week**, **this month**, or **this year**, you can use the present perfect—especially if the activity is still happening or not yet finished.

Examples:

- I've had three coffees **today**.
Hoy he tomado tres cafés.
- She has worked a lot **this week**.
Esta semana ha trabajado mucho.
- We've gone to the gym three times **this month**.
Este mes hemos ido al gimnasio tres veces.
- They haven't taken any vacations **this year**.
Este año no han tomado vacaciones.

2. Grammar: Structure

The present perfect is formed using the **auxiliary verb have** (or **has** for he/she/it) + the **past participle** of the main verb.

I/you/we/they have + past participle

He/she/it has + past participle

Important!

The **have** in this tense is NOT *tener* in Spanish. It is **haber**—an auxiliary verb.

-  *I have eaten.* → *He comido.*
-  *Tengo comido.*

So:

| have/has = haber (not tener)

3. Time Expressions with the Present Perfect

Here are common expressions we use with the present perfect, with examples and translations:

Yet (used in negative sentences and questions)

- I haven't finished **yet**.
Todavía no he terminado.
 - Have you eaten **yet**?
¿Has comido ya?
-

Already (something happened earlier than expected)

- She's **already** left. *Ya se ha ido.*
-

Just (a very short time ago)

- I've **just** seen him. *Lo acabo de ver.*
-

Recently / Lately (in the recent past)

- I've **recently** started a new job.
Recientemente he empezado un nuevo trabajo.
 - Have you seen him **lately**?
¿Lo has visto últimamente?
-

So far / Up to now (until this moment)

- We've had ten customers **so far**.

Hasta ahora hemos tenido diez clientes.

- **Up to now**, they've done everything right.

Hasta ahora, lo han hecho todo bien.

Never (not once)

- I've **never** been to Japan. *Nunca he estado en Japón.*
-

Always (habit or experience)

- She's **always** been very kind. *Siempre ha sido muy amable.*
-

Ever (used in questions or negatives)

- Have you **ever** tried sushi?

¿Alguna vez has probado el sushi?

- No, I haven't **ever** done that.

No, nunca he hecho eso.